

RUNBOOK | INTERNAL - DO NOT FORWARD

Runbook: How to Issue a Credit in the Admin Tool

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Classification	Internal - do not forward
Related	Billing Disputes runbook (OPS-BIL-2026-05), On-Call Roster (C rotation)

Purpose

The mechanics of issuing an account credit. This runbook does not tell you whether to issue one; the Billing Disputes runbook does. Come here after that decision is made.

Who can

Amount	Who	Approval
Under \$500	Support (tier 2 and above), Billing on-call	None beyond the ticket
\$500 and above	Finance only	Finance approver in the tool
Any refund to payment method	Finance only	Finance approver in the tool

The admin tool enforces this. If the Credit button is disabled for the amount you entered, you are not the right person to issue it. Do not split a \$700 credit into two \$350 credits. The tool flags it, Finance sees it, and it is the fastest way to lose your credit permission.

Credit versus refund

A **credit** reduces the customer's next invoice. It is what Support issues.

A **refund** returns money to the original payment method within ten business days. Only Finance issues refunds, at any amount. If the customer wants money back rather than a credit, assign to Finance with the details, even if the amount is under \$500.

Credits from billing errors that remain when a customer cancels are converted to refunds by Finance. Goodwill credits are not converted.

Before you start

You have, from the Billing Disputes runbook:

- Ticket ID.
- Invoice ID the credit relates to.
- Amount, and confirmation it is under \$500.
- Class: billing error, unused prepaid, or goodwill.
- Confirmation the request is inside the 30-day window from invoice date, or that it is a billing error Finance has approved outside the window.

Missing any of these: go back to the disputes runbook.

Steps

1. Open the customer's workspace in the admin tool.
2. Go to **Administration** → **Billing** → **Credit**.
3. **Invoice.** Select the invoice from the dropdown. Credits must reference an invoice; unlinked credits are not permitted. If the invoice is not in the list, it is more than 12 months old or belongs to another workspace; stop and check.
4. **Amount.** Enter the amount in USD. The tool shows the invoice total and the remaining creditable balance. You cannot credit more than the invoice total minus prior credits on it.
5. **Reason code.** Pick one:

Code	Use for
BILLING_ERROR	Duplicate, post-cancellation charge, wrong plan fee, usage on wrong workspace
UNUSED_PREPAID	Prepaid volume unused at cancel or downgrade
GOODWILL	Customer configuration cases where we chose to help. Under \$500, once per 12 months per account.
SERVICE_TERMS	Finance only. Order form service commitments after an incident.
OTHER	Requires a note and Finance review. Avoid.

1. **Ticket ID.** Required. The tool links the credit to the ticket and posts a note back to it.
2. **Note.** One or two sentences a Finance auditor could read cold: what happened, why this amount. "Duplicate invoice INV-2026-08-1132 issued after cancellation confirmed 2026-08-14; crediting full plan fee" is good. "Customer unhappy" is not.
3. **Preview.** The tool shows the credit, the invoice it applies to, and the customer's next projected invoice with the credit applied. Check the workspace name one more time.
4. **Confirm.** The credit posts immediately. The customer's Admins receive an automatic email with the amount and the reason category (not your note). The credit appears on the customer's Administration → Billing page under Credits.

After

- The tool posts to the ticket. Add your customer-facing reply using the `billing-dispute-resolved` macro. Tell them the credit amount and that it applies to their next invoice.
- Do not tell them a date the credit will "arrive." It is not a payment; it reduces the next invoice on the billing date.
- If the customer replies asking for a refund instead, reassign to Finance. Do not reverse the credit yourself; Finance handles the conversion so it is not double counted.

Reversing a credit

Only Finance can reverse a credit. If you issued one in error, post in `#support-ops` with the credit ID and assign the ticket to Finance the same day. Do not issue a negative credit and do not issue a second credit to "fix" the first.

Things that go wrong

Credit button disabled. Amount is \$500 or more, or you lack the permission tier, or the invoice already has a Finance hold on it. Hover shows which. Assign to Finance.

Invoice not in the dropdown. Wrong workspace (customer has more than one), or invoice older than 12 months. Check the invoice ID against the workspace. Anything older than 12 months is Finance.

Customer asks for the credit on a different workspace. Credits are per workspace and per invoice. A credit on workspace A cannot be applied to workspace B's invoice. Finance can handle cross-workspace situations for the same billing entity; assign to them.

Customer cites a 45-day window. That is the outdated Finance PDF (FIN-REF-2025-03). Current policy is 30 days from the invoice date. Handle per the Billing Disputes runbook. The admin tool's window check uses 30 days and will flag a request outside it; do not override the flag.

Done when

- Credit posted with invoice, amount, reason code, ticket ID, and an auditable note.
- Customer replied to with the amount and "applies to your next invoice."
- Ticket status set to resolved, or reassigned to Finance if a refund was requested.

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
v1.0	2025-10-14	Initial runbook after admin tool credit flow shipped
v1.1	2026-02-03	Added reason code table; added 45-day note
v1.2	2026-06-09	Added reversal section; added cross-workspace case